Institution: Royal Ontario Museum
Registration Number: 919.5.23
Beazley Archive Number: 204579
Fabric: Athenian, red-figure
Shape: Kylix (drinking cup), Type B
Attribution: Painter of Paris Gigantomachy
Date: Late Archaic Period; c. 490- 460 BCE
Dimensions: Height: 9.7cm; Diameter: 30.6 cm
Provenance: Sigmund Samuel Collection

Fabric, Technique, Shape & Condition Attic red-figure kylix, Type B, in characteristic orange-red Attic clay.[1] Figures rendered in reserved clay against a black-glazed ground; relief contour lines and dilute glaze used for interior modelling of figures and drapery. The vessel is broken and restored, with repair seams visible across the body; missing fragments have been filled with plaster, and the missing decorative elements have been left unpainted. The figural decoration is largely intact, with some losses on the exterior left side of Side B. Shape intact.

Iconography The interior tondo depicts a symposiast reclining on a kline, turning his head to the right (Fig. 1). A kylix is looped over his fingers in the characteristic gesture of kottabos, a drinking game in which wine lees (residual dregs from wine) were flicked at a target. He also cradles a skyphos on his side. The scene situates the vessel within the symposium and reflects its intended user in its iconography.

Fig. 1. *Attic red-figure kylix, tondo: symposiast reclining on a kline with kylix and skyphos*, attributed to the Painter of the Paris Gigantomachy, c. 490–460 BCE. Royal Ontario Museum, Toronto, acc. no. 919.5.23. Image © Royal Ontario Museum

Both exterior sides carry athletic training scenes (Fig. 2**)**. Each depicts two naked youths engaged in boxing, supervised by a clothed trainer who looks on. The trainer is distinguished from the athletes by his dress (cloak, boots, and a fillet), and he leans on a staff. Behind the figures, athletic equipment (rods, thong, and a discus) is depicted suspended or placed against the wall. The painted hanging objects establish a wall plane and locates the action within an interior architectural space without recourse to perspective depth. The detailing of the trainer's dress and the background equipment indicates an interest in the social and institutional context of athletic training, not merely the athletic act itself.

The pairing of an athletic scene on the exterior with a symposium scene on the interior is a well-attested compositional

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[1] Classical Art Research Centre, University of Oxford. "Cups and Other Drinking Vessels." *Introduction to Greek Pottery: Shapes*. Accessed April 1 2026. https://www.carc.ox.ac.uk/carc/resources/Introduction-to-Greek-Pottery/Shapes/Cups-and-other-drinking-vessels.

strategy on Late Archaic kylikes.[2] It articulates the complementary ideals of physical discipline and convivial leisure which structured elite male civic life in Ancient Greece. The kottabos player on the interior and the trainer in the athletic scene together present two registers of aristocratic male identity (bodily discipline and social ritual) in a deliberate counterpoint across the vessel's interior and exterior surfaces.

Fig. 2. *Attic red-figure kylix, Side A: two youths boxing supervised by a draped trainer*, attributed to the Painter of the Paris Gigantomachy, c. 490–460 BCE. Royal Ontario Museum, Toronto, acc. no. 919.5.23. Image from Steiner, Ann and Jenifer Neils, "An Imported Attic Kylix from the Sanctuary at Poggio Colla," *Etruscan Studies* 21, no. 1–2 (2018): 98–145. https://doi.org/10.1515/etst-2018-0010.

The visual consistency between the trainer and symposiast figure is notable. The cloak, boots, and fillet on the figures are articulated in a remarkably consistent manner. This parallel may suggest a deliberate compositional strategy linking the two scenes (athletics and symposium) as complementary expressions of the same aristocratic male identity.

Attribution & Dating Attributed to the Painter of Paris Gigantomachy, a pupil of the Brygos Painter who mainly decorated cups, as well as amphorae, lekythoi and oinochoai. Attribution is supported by the presence of a boxing scene, which is a recurring subject within the painter's corpus. Kylikes attributed to the painter were found widely distributed across Etruria and northern Italy, where the shape and subject matter seemed to have been well-known to audiences. This kylix is cited within Steiner and Neils' study of a closely related kylix by the same painter excavated at the Etruscan sanctuary of Poggio Colla as part of a broader group of near-identical workshop productions which circulated in non-Greek contexts.[3] A date of approximately 490-460 BCE is consistent with the known active period and stylistic evidence of the figural work, which is further confirmed on the Beazley Archive entry.[4]

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[2] Steiner, Ann and Neils, Jenifer. "An Imported Attic Kylix from the Sanctuary at Poggio Colla" *Etruscan Studies* 21, no. 1-2 (2018): 98-145. https://doi.org/10.1515/etst-2018-0010

[3] Ibid.

[4] Classical Art Research Centre, University of Oxford. "Beazley Archive Pottery Database." Record F16D2CBB-ECF5-410B-9ABD-BE61BEEAB89D (Vase no. 204579). Accessed April 1 2026. https://www.beazley.ox.ac.uk/record/F16D2CBB-ECF5-410B-9ABD-BE61BEEAB89D.

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Kerameikos.org. "Painter of the Paris Gigantomachy." Canonical URI: https://kerameikos.org/id/the_paris_gigantomachy_painter. Accessed April 1.

Royal Ontario Museum. "Attic Red-Figure Kylix with a Symposiast and a Boxing Scene." Acc. no. 919.5.23. Attributed to the Painter of the Paris Gigantomachy, ca. 490–480 BCE. Sigmund Samuel Collection. Accessed March 17 2026. https://collections.rom.on.ca/objects/349771.

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